

考研精读 | The Guardian



Women also helped to fund the slave trade

女性也曾参与资助奴隶贸易

难度评级：★★★★☆

【 Para.1 】

More than 1,000 women invested in the slave trade, challenging the **conventional notion** that they were passive beneficiaries and largely fought for its abolition. Researchers found women bought, sold and **brokered** shares in the Royal African Company (RAC), South Sea Company, and other separate **ventures**, and used profits from the **trafficking** of enslaved Africans to secure financial independence and provide for their families. By the time the RAC, which trafficked about 150,000 enslaved people, was dissolved in 1752, women made up about 10% of shareholders.

超过 1,000 名女性曾投资于奴隶贸易，这一事实挑战了传统观念——即女性只是奴隶贸易的被动受益者，并且大多致力于推动废除奴隶贸易。研究人员发现，女性曾买卖并居间交易皇家非洲公司（RAC）、南海公司以及其他独立贸易项目的股份；她们还利用贩运被

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文章导读：

一项新研究发现超千名女性曾投资大西洋奴隶贸易，颠覆了女性仅是废奴推动者、被动受益者的传统认知。她们涵盖各阶层，购买交易奴隶贸易公司股份，深度参与运营，借此获取经济独立。当时法律让未婚与寡妇女性拥有财产权，成为重要资金来源。学者指出档案仍缺少被奴役非洲女性的详细记录，需更多史料还原其经历。

conventional adj. /kən'venʃənl/ based on what is traditionally done or believed 传统的，惯例的【考研英语词汇】

notion n. /'nəʊʃn/ an idea, belief or opinion about something 概念，观念，看法【考研英语词汇】

abolish v. /ə'bɒlɪʃ/ to officially end a law, system, institution etc 废除，废止【考研英语词汇】

Slavery was **abolished** in the British Empire in 1833. 大英帝国于1833年废除了奴隶制。

broker /'brɒkə/

n. A broker is a person whose job is to buy and sell securities, foreign money, real estate, or goods for other people. 经纪人；掮客

v. If a country or government brokers an agreement, a ceasefire, or a round of talks, they try to negotiate or arrange it. 斡旋

The United Nations **brokered** a peace in Mogadishu at the end of March. 联合国于3月底在摩加迪沙促成了一场和平谈判。

venture n. /'ventʃə(r)/ a business project or activity, especially one that involves taking risks (尤指有风险的) 企业，商业，投机活动，经营项目

trafficking n. /'træfɪkɪŋ/ the activity of buying, selling or illegally moving people or goods 贩运；非法买卖；非法交易

register n. /'redʒɪstə(r)/ an official list of names or items 登记簿，花名册【考研英语词汇】

exclusively adv. /ɪk'skluːsɪvli/ only; no one else 唯一地，专门地，仅【考研英语词汇】

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transatlantic adj. /'trænzət'læntɪk/ crossing the Atlantic Ocean 横渡大西洋的；横越大西洋的

range v. /reɪndʒ/ to vary between two limits; to include a variety (在一定范围内) 变化；包括（各种）【考研英语词汇】

The children's ages **range** from 8 to 15. 孩子们的年龄从8岁到15岁不等。

archive n. /'ɑːkaɪv/ a collection of historical documents or records 档案，档案室

household n. /'haʊshəʊld/ all the people living together in a house 家庭，一户人【考研英语词汇】

奴役非洲人所得的利润来实现经济独立，并供养自己的家庭。到 1752 年皇家非洲公司解散时——该公司曾贩运约 15 万名被奴役者——女性约占其股东总数的 10%。

【 Para.2 】

The **Register** of British Slave Traders, revealed **exclusively** in the Guardian, shows women from across society played an active role in financing and sustaining the **transatlantic** trafficking of enslaved Africans. Investors **ranged** from queens and princesses to titled nobility, merchants, shopkeepers and cowherds.

《英国奴隶贸易商名录》此次由《卫报》独家披露。名录显示，来自社会各阶层的女性都曾积极参与资助跨大西洋贩运被奴役非洲人，并维系这一贸易体系。投资者上至王后与公主，下至受封贵族、商人、店主，乃至牧牛人。

【 Para.3 】

The **archives** include letters in which women discuss profits from “African stock”, while company records show one investor, Helen Gladman, asking the RAC to transport a young African girl from Sherbrooke Island in Sierra Leone to England to serve in her **household**. Researchers found women were involved “at almost every level” of the company’s activities. They acted as brokers, supplied goods traded on Africa’s Atlantic coast, managed company

guise n. /gaɪz/ the way something appears, often hiding the truth 外观，伪装，幌子

backing n. /'bækɪŋ/ money, support or approval given to someone or something 资助，支持【考研英语大纲词汇】

voyage n. /'vɔɪdʒ/ a long journey by sea or in space 航行，航程【考研英语大纲词汇】

spidery adj. /'spɪdəri/ thin and bending in many directions, like a spider’s legs 细长而扭曲的，像蜘蛛腿般的

marital adj. /'mærɪtl/ relating to marriage 婚姻的【考研英语大纲词汇】

aristocrat n. /'ærɪstəkræt/ a member of the highest social class 贵族

crucial adj. /'kruːʃl/ extremely important because it will affect the final result 至关重要的【考研英语大纲词汇】

narrative n. /'nærətɪv/ a description of events, especially one that gives a particular understanding 叙事，说法，叙述【考研英语大纲词汇】

oppression n. /ə'preʃn/ the cruel and unfair use of power to control a group of people 压迫，压制

overturn v. /ˌəʊvə'tɜːn/ to officially change a legal decision; to reject or overturn 推翻，撤销；颠覆
The court **overturned** the earlier verdict. 法院撤销了先前的判决。

misconception n. /'mɪskən'sepʃn/ a wrong idea or understanding of something 误解，错误观念

compile v. /kəm'paɪl/ to collect information and arrange it in a list, book or record 编纂，汇编【考研英语大纲词汇】

The data was **compiled** from over 2,000 surveys. 这些数据汇集自2000多份调查。

compensation n. /'kɒmpen'seɪʃn/ something, especially money, given to compensate for loss, injury or damage 补偿，赔偿【考研英语大纲词汇】

distinguished adj. /dɪ'stɪŋɡwɪʃt/ successful, respected and admired for achievement 杰出的，卓越的【考研英语大纲词汇】

startling adj. /'stɑːtlɪŋ/ unusual and surprising; difficult to believe 令人吃惊的，惊人的

agency n. /'edʒənsi/ the capacity of a person to act and make their own choices 能动性，行动力；代理机构【考研英语大纲词汇】

transmitter n. /trænz'mɪtə(r)/ a person or thing that passes something on to others 传递者，传播者；发射机【考研英语大纲词汇】

minutes n. /'mɪnɪts/ a written record of what was said at a meeting 会议纪要【考研英语大纲词汇】

petition v. /pə'tɪʃn/ to ask the government or an authority for something formally 请愿，正式请求【考研英语大纲词汇】
Workers **petitioned** the mayor for safer conditions. 工人们向市长请愿，要求改善安全条件。

stutter v. /'stʌtə(r)/ to speak with difficulty; to make uneven progress 口吃；磕磕绊绊地进行
The economy **stuttered** through the decade. 这十年间经济步履维艰。

well n. /wel/ a deep hole sunk to obtain water; a source of something 井；源泉

property and used their familial and social networks to strengthen the company's finances and political influence.

档案中收录了一些女性讨论“非洲股票”收益的信件；与此同时，公司记录显示，一名投资者海伦·格莱德曼曾要求皇家非洲公司把一名来自塞拉利昂舍布鲁克岛的非洲女孩运往英国，供她家中役使。研究人员发现，女性几乎参与了公司的各个层级。她们充当经纪人，为非洲大西洋沿岸的贸易提供商品，管理公司财产，并利用家庭和社会关系网络来增强公司的财务实力及政治影响力。

【 Para.4 】

Lila O'Leary Chambers, a lecturer at the University of Cambridge who researched women's involvement for the register project, said: "This research really shows that this was not just a flash in the pan. "Across the entirety of the Royal African Company and its various **guises**, there were women contributing financially and expecting a financial return from the slave trade."

剑桥大学讲师莉拉·奥利里·钱伯斯曾为该名录项目研究女性参与奴隶贸易的情况。她说：“这项研究确实表明，这绝非昙花一现。纵观皇家非洲公司及其各种不同形式的发展历程，一直都有女性在为其提供资金，并期待从奴隶贸易中获得经济回报。”

【 Para.5 】

Women invested from the earliest years of enslavement, from Queen Elizabeth I's **backing** in the 1560s to Lady

►今日句子分析

Para 13. Under English law, women who were single or widowed were in control of their own property and could operate as legal persons while married women could not. Al 根据英国法律，单身或丧偶女性可以自主支配自己的财产，并能够以独立法律主体的身份开展活动；而已婚女性则不能。



主句:

状语: Under English law;

主句主语: women;

who 引导的定语从句修饰 women:

系动词: were; 表语: single or widowed;

主句谓语 1: were; 表语: in control of their own property;
(连词): and;

主句谓语 2: could operate as legal persons;

在 while 引导的状语从句中:

主语: married women; 谓语: could not. (后省略与前文重复的动词部分)

本句主干为 women were in control of their own property and could operate as legal persons, 包含两个并列谓语。句首 Under English law 为介词短语作状语; 主语 women 后接 who were single or widowed 引导的限制性定语从句, 限定"单身或丧偶女性"; 两个谓语 were in control of... 与 could operate as... 由 and 连接, 共用同一主语。句末 while 引导对比状语从句, 将已婚女性与之对照, 从句中为避免重复, 省略了与主句相同的 operate as legal persons, 仅保留情态动词 could not, 这是英语中常见的省略结构。翻译时, while 从句宜译出"而.....则不能"的对比语气, 并将省略部分补出, 使中文意思完整。

Craven's £1,000 loan financing a **voyage** to the Gambia through the Guinea Company. Some investors, unable to write their names, signed company records with a **spidery** "X".

早在奴役贸易起步之初，女性就已参与投资：从 16 世纪 60 年代伊丽莎白一世女王的支持，到克雷文夫人通过几内亚公司向一趟前往冈比亚的航行提供 1,000 英镑贷款。还有一些投资者甚至不会书写自己的名字，只能在公司记录上用歪歪扭扭的 "X" 签名。

【 Para.6 】

The research identifies 1,100 female investors across the histories of the RAC, the South Sea Company, and other separate ventures, though the true number is likely to have been higher. Of the 457 women whose **marital** status could be identified, almost half were widows and just over 42% were unmarried. Of the 7% who were married, most were **aristocrats**.

这项研究在皇家非洲公司、南海公司以及其他独立贸易项目的历史记录中确认了 1,100 名女性投资者，不过实际人数很可能更高。在婚姻状况可考证的 457 名女性中，近一半是寡妇，略高于 42% 的人为未婚女性。而在已婚的 7% 女性中，大多数属于贵族阶层。

【 Para.7 】

For many, the investments were **crucial** to gaining economic independence. Some became active traders and

➤ 写作积累

Para 4. This research really shows that this was not just a flash in the pan.

flash in the pan 原指老式燧发枪的火药在火药池中闪燃却未真正发射子弹，引申为"一时轰动但很快销声匿迹的人或事"，强调短暂、缺乏持续性。相比 momentary success 或 temporary phenomenon，它更具画面感和口语色彩，常用于否定句 (not a flash in the pan) 来强调某事的长期性。例如：Her success was no flash in the pan; she had been training for years. (她的成功绝非昙花一现，她已坚持训练多年。) 在写作中，flash in the pan 可用于论证某趋势、某现象具有持续性，增强说服力。

Para 10. For Chambers, the accumulation of more than 1,000 names was itself a "gut punch" ...

gut punch 字面意为"对着腹部的一拳"，引申为"令人震惊或深受打击的消息/经历"，强调情感上的重击，比 shock 或 blow 更具画面感和冲击力。该短语多作可数名词，常搭配 be a gut punch for/to sb. 例如：Losing the championship in the final seconds was a gut punch for the team. (在最后几秒丢掉冠军，对这支队伍是沉重一击。) 在写作中，gut punch 可用于描述研究发现、历史事实或社会事件带来的情感冲击，使论述更有感染力。

traded shares for friends and family, Chambers said. “It was not a career as they would see it, but we might think: this has become your job.”

对许多女性而言，这些投资是实现经济独立的关键。钱伯斯说，其中一些人还成为积极的交易者，替亲友买卖股份。她说：“她们不会把这看作一份职业，但我们或许可以这样理解：这已经成为了你的工作。”

【 Para.8 】

Chambers said the research directly challenged the conventional **narrative** that “white women come in at the point of abolition, see the suffering of enslaved people, identify with that oppression, and then work either to reform or ultimately abolish the slave trade and slavery itself”.

钱伯斯表示，这项研究直接挑战了一种传统叙事：即“白人女性直到废奴阶段才登上历史舞台，她们看到被奴役者遭受的苦难，对这份压迫感同身受，随后致力于推动改革或者最终废除奴隶贸易以及奴隶制度本身”。

【 Para.9 】

Work to **overturn** that **misconception** builds on decades of scholarship by historians from the Caribbean and west Africa, including Eric Williams, Elsa Goveia and Walter Rodney. More recent public-facing projects, such as the Legacies of British Slavery archive **compiled** by historians at University College London, have helped bring this history to wider audiences. The archive revealed that women were among those connected to the ownership of enslaved people who received **compensation** after slavery was abolished in a large portion of the empire in 1833, she said. Enslaved people received nothing.

推翻这一误解的研究，建立在加勒比地区和西非历史学家数十年来的学术成果之上，其中包括埃里克·威廉姆斯、埃尔莎·戈维娅和沃尔特·罗德尼。近年来，一些面向公众的历史项目也让这段历史进入更广泛的视野，例如由伦敦大学学院历史学家整理的《英国奴隶制遗产》档案。她说，该档案显示，1833 年大英帝国大部分地区废除奴隶制后，与被奴役者所有权相关的人获得了赔偿，女性也在获赔者之列。而被奴役者什么也没有得到。

【Para.10】

For Chambers, the accumulation of more than 1,000 names was itself a “gut punch” because of the lack of similar information about enslaved African women. Olivette Otele, a **distinguished** professor of the legacies and memory of slavery at Soas University of London, said while the lack of comparable detail about enslaved African women remained **startling**, “the more we know about enslavers, the better chance we have to know about enslaved women from the archives, because sometimes through diaries you can find more details”.

对钱伯斯而言，能够汇总出 1,000 多个名字本身就给人“带来沉重冲击”，因为关于被奴役非洲女性的类似资料却极其匮乏。伦敦大学亚非学院研究奴隶制遗产与记忆的杰出教授奥利维特·奥特尔表示，尽管关于被奴役非洲女性的同等详实资料依然匮乏得惊人，但“我们对奴役者了解得越多，就越有可能从档案中进一步了解被奴役女性，因为有时可以通过日记找到更多细节”。

【Para.11】

She added that archives alone could not tell the full history, and future research should look at other evidence to help recover the lives and **agency** of enslaved women. “These women were the **transmitters** and the holders of their cultures wherever they were taken from,” she said. “Through

food, music, and dancing, it’s about resistance and agency, and they transmitted that.”

她补充说，仅凭档案无法讲述完整的历史，未来的研究还应寻找其他证据，以帮助还原被奴役女性的生活以及她们的主体性。她说：“无论这些女性被带往何处，她们都是自身文化的传递者和守护者。通过食物、音乐和舞蹈，这体现的是抵抗与主体性，而她们也将这种文化传承了下去。”

【Para.12】

The research also found that because female investors seemingly did not vote or hold board positions, they often relied on informal efforts to influence and shape a company. Meeting **minutes** show women acting as witnesses, running the meeting house, delivering the goods exchanged for African lives, **petitioning** for wages, passing information and, most importantly, lending money and buying and selling shares.

研究还发现，由于女性投资者似乎没有投票权，也没有担任董事会职务，她们往往依靠非正式的方式来影响并塑造公司。会议记录显示，女性曾担任见证人、管理会议场所、交付那些用非洲人的生命换取的商品、为工资问题请愿、传递信息，而最重要的是，她们还会出借资金以及买卖股份。

【Para.13】

Under English law, women who were single or widowed were in control of their own property and could operate as legal persons while married women could not. “That becomes really important for the Royal African Company as it **stutters** between financial crises,” Chambers said. “Women provided this important **well** of capital.”

根据英国法律，单身或丧偶女性可以自主支配自己的财产，并能够以独立法律主体的身份开展活动；而已婚女性则不能。“这一点对于皇家非洲公司而言非常重要，因为公司在一次次金融危机之间步履蹒跚，”钱伯斯说。“女性提供了这一重要的资本来源。”

【Para.14】

In the early 18th century, the RAC secretary, John Perry, wrote to female investors urging them to exchange company debts for shares and persuade friends and relatives to do the same. Chambers said: “That is a financial project, but it is also a political one, because he knows that they might not hold official positions, but women were very influential with their family members and with the way companies were perceived.”

18世纪初，皇家非洲公司秘书约翰·佩里致信女性投资者，敦促她们将公司债务兑换为股份，并劝说亲友也这样做。钱伯斯说：“这是一项金融举措，但同时也是一种政治安排。因为他知道，她们可能没有正式的职位，但女性对家庭成员以及公司在人们心目中的形象都具有很大的影响力。”